FREE LESSON PACK · HISTORY · 1ST AND 2ND YEAR

HERBICIDE GAMES

The arena then and now

Who fought in the Colosseum, why the Romans came to watch, and what we no longer see today.



THE KILLING WE PAY FOR, MADE VISIBLE.

HERBICIDE GAMES
21–23 APRIL 2027 · ROME

The arena in Roman times

I

Captured slaves and poor people fought in the arena.

II

Did you know they used animals back in the day to fight people?

III

Did you know that each level of the Colosseum is built from a lighter material the higher it goes?

IV

People were given free bread during the games, to keep them on the emperor's side.

Two gladiators, a murmillo and a thraex · still from the Herbicide Games Arena Bus (3D render)



PART 2 · IN CLASS

Talk about it

1 Would you watch the games in the Colosseum? Why (not)?

2 Why be vegan or vegetarian?

3 How many people do you think were killed in the arena?

TASK

Write one page about the daily life of a Roman citizen.

FOR THE TEACHER · QUESTION 3

The number usually quoted is about **400,000 people** and around **1 million animals** over the Colosseum's whole history. Nobody knows exactly: treat it as an estimate. The opening games alone reportedly killed about 9,000 animals in 100 days.

Source: rome.us, "How many people and animals died in the Colosseum".

PART 3 · NOW

What we don't see today

83 billion

land animals slaughtered for meat worldwide in one year (2022). Most are chickens, then ducks and pigs.

41 %

of global deforestation from 2001 to 2023 is linked to beef, mostly forest cleared for cattle pasture.

15,415 L

of water used for 1 kg of beef, mostly rain on grass and feed crops. 1 kg of vegetables: 322 L.

6 minutes

is all it takes today to slaughter 1 million land animals: as many as the Colosseum killed in its whole history.

Sources: Our World in Data (FAO), "More than 80 billion land animals are slaughtered for meat every year" · Our World in Data, "Beef production in Brazil has been the largest driver of global deforestation", based on Singh & Persson (2026), Nature Food · Water Footprint Network, Mekonnen & Hoekstra (2012). 6 minutes = 83 billion a year ÷ 525,600 minutes.

THE FESTIVAL

Herbicide Games

21–23 April 2027 · Rome. Three days of gladiator fights, talks and a plant-based closing dinner. The Romans watched every kill. We pay for billions and see none.

The killing we pay for, made visible.



SCAN FOR THE FESTIVAL